

KISSINGER

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First Draft

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BOOK 1: A WORLD DESTROYED

Qui desiderat pacem, praeparet bellum.

Let him who desires peace, prepare for war.

Vegetius

EXT. FÜRTH, VARIOUS STREETS - EVENING

We fly over a German town that lacks the picturesque quality of neighboring Nürnberg yet still retains some medieval elements. As the camera comes down, a dozen people of different professions walk toward a common destination.

The Rathaus is bedecked with bright, red National Socialist flags and swastikas. Workers take down the Königswartstrasse sign to replace it with a new text: "Adolf-Hitler-Strasse". A portrait of the Führer is being hanged right below it.

In front of the St. Michaels Church the town preacher Paul Fronmüller stands in front of 250 people. His serious face anticipates the historical significance of what is to come.

FRONMÜLLER

Lasset uns Gott danken... denn er hat
Adolf Hitler zu uns geschickt.

Let us thank God... for he sent us
Adolf Hitler.

A few people cheer. Probably not as many as expected since some view this gathering as a religious ceremony. Those who do not cheer (mostly old people) fold their hands to a prayer. Some even close their eyes.

FRONMÜLLER (cont'd)

Er ist unser Retter vor dem
außländischen Ansturm der gottlosen
Horde, der Erbauer eines neuen Reichs
in welchem die christliche Tradition
das Fundament unseres Lebens
darstellt.

He is our savior from the foreign
onslaught of the godless horde, the
builder of a new kingdom in which the
Christian tradition stands as the
foundation for all our lives.

Peter, a 12 year old boy stares at the speaker before being handed Der Stürmer, a magazine that features a grinning Jewish banker with a dollar and communism symbol behind him. The headline reads "Die Weltbank".

FRONMÜLLER (cont'd)
Daher möchte ich, am Vorabend zu
Michaelis-Kirchweih, über die Gefahr
der Juden in Fürth sprechen..

Therefore, on the eve of St.
Michael's Church Fair, I would like
to speak about the danger posed by
Jews in Fürth...

Albert Neuburger, a leading member of the Jewish community, shakes his head and moves on with his day. We follow the man to the synagogue a few hundred meters away.

EXT. FÜRTH, SPORTPLATZ - EVENING

Heinz Lion und Heinz Kissinger, both 14 are watching the local Jewish teams compete in a game of soccer. There are only a dozen people watching.

The striker from the red team runs past the white players and scores a goal.

LION
Ach Mist! Schon wieder ein Tor.

Oh crap! Another goal.

The wooden tablet in the middle of the field gets updated to show 4-2 for the red players.

Even though not playing, the psychological involvement of Lion causes him to sweat and turn red. In contrast Kissinger is more detached and tries to analyze the situation.

KISSINGER
Weißt du wie die Italiener spielen?

Do you know how the Italians play?

Lion shakes his head without looking at Kissinger.

KISSINGER (cont'd)
Ihr System ist es, das andere Team
wahnsinning zu machen indem man so
viele Spieler als Verteidiger hinten
lässt.

(MORE)

KISSINGER (cont'd)

Their system is to drive the other
team crazy by leaving as many players
at the back as defenders.

Dadurch wird es sehr schwierig ein
Tor zu machen wenn 10 Spieler davor
aufgereiht sind.

This makes it very difficult to score
a goal when there are 10 players
lined up in front of it.

Now the white players have a lead.

LION

(to the player)

Ach komm schon Ezra!

Oh come on Ezra!

Kissinger takes a sip from a lemonade that the two shared.

KISSINGER

Hast du mir überhaupt zugehört?

Did you even listen to me?

Lion waits for the shoot which fails.

LION

Nein!

No!

Kissinger shakes his head.

LION (cont'd)

Aber wieso spielst Du dann nie in der
Verteidigung?

But then why don't you ever play
defense?

Now he grins.

KISSINGER

Nun, die guten Spieler müssen schon
weiter vorne sein.

Well, the good players must be
further forward.

EXT. FÜRTH, VARIOUS STREETS - EVENING

The two boys part ways at a street crossing.

LION
Bis morgen Heinz!

See you tomorrow Heinz!

Kissinger waves his hand.

He finishes the lemonade, and puts the empty bottle back in his school bag.

A group of boys from school is walking towards him. One of them is carrying Der Stürmer, it is Peter.

Now Kissinger becomes a bit nervous thinking of crossing the street. However a car just drives past him and honks. He decides to go straight ahead.

Trying to appear confident (but failing to do so) he quickly goes through the group and sighs as he walks past them. But he can't move any further.

Someone has grabbed his school bag. An older colleague slams his foot into Kissingers legs making him, and his glasses fall to the ground.

Peter bends down to stare him in the eyes.

PETER
Hallo Heinz. Du weißt schon das Juden
hier nichts verloren haben.

Hello Heinz. You do know that Jews
have no business here.

Kissinger breathes heavily. Peter spits on his face. He pulls his hair and slaps him hard. The other boys laugh.

PETER (cont'd)
(to his friends)
Wer möchte ihn noch etwas sagen?

Who else would like to say something
to him?

A big guy raises his hand. Peter indicates that he should come forward.

Instead of saying something, the big guy kicks Kissinger into the stomach.

He almost throws up and looks behind him. Two girls come from the other side. The viewer only sees their legs and hears their steps.

PETER (cont'd)
(almost whispering)
Oh scheiße. Anneliese ist hier.

Oh shit. Anneliese is here.

Peter subtly to the girls.

PETER (cont'd)
Wir sollten verschwinden. Kommt.

We should go. Come on.

The group runs away. Kissinger, tries to get up slowly.

We see from his perspective how he looks up to the brunette girl. Her face is completely blurred... until he puts on his glasses.

We look down on Kissinger from the girls perspective. Now we see his bruised face.

KISSINGER
Oh. Hallo Anneliese. Wie geht es dir?

Oh. Hello Anneliese. How are you?

Her friend looks worried.

ANNELIESE
Was ist passiert?

What happened?

INT. FÜRTH, JEWISH SCHOOL - AFTERNOON

Leo Höchster, an 18 year old boy stands in front of six members of the Esra Orthodox youth group. They include Lion and Kissinger.

To show off his newfound authority as a teacher, Höchster walks with slow but determined steps back and forth, "controlling" the correct reading of the Torah.

The camera pans from one student to the next, ending at Lion who has fallen asleep.

Kissinger looks Höchster approaching and slightly shakes Lion's shoulder.

KISSINGER
(Whispering)
Wach auf.

Wake up.

It takes a few moments for Lion to realise where he is. He quickly goes back to the reading, flying over the text with his finger.

Höchster stands behind the two boys and clears his throat.

HÖCHSTER
Nun, wer möchte uns die Muktzeh
erklären.

Now, who wants to explain the Muktzeh
to us.

Lion closes the book and turns his head to the group.

LION
Die Muktzeh beschreibt Gegenstände
welche am Sabbat nicht benutzt werden
können. Man unterscheidet zwischen
verschiedenen Kategorien der Muktzeh.
Die Muktzeh Machmat Issur verbietet
Gegenstände die für spezielle
Aktivitäten benutzt werden...

The Muktzeh describes items that
cannot be used on the Sabbath. There
are different categories of Muktzeh.
The Muktzeh Machmat Issur prohibits
items that are used for specific
activities...

Lion looks at his table and grabs the pen, lying on his open notebook. He holds it up like King Arthurs sword.

LION (cont'd)
... zum Beispiel einen Bleistift da
Schreiben am Sabbat verboten ist.

... for example a pencil since
writing is forbidden on the Sabbath.

We see Kissingers notebook which contains sketches of a football field. Dots indicate players and arrows their movement.

HÖCHSTER
Sehr gut Heinz! Wer möchte
fortfahren?
(MORE)

HÖCHSTER (cont'd)
Very good, Heinz! Who wants to
continue?

Expressing a sporty competitiveness, Kissinger raises his hand.

KISSINGER
Weiters gibt es die Muktzeh Machmat
Mi'us welche hässliche oder dreckige
Gegenstände verbietet.

There is also the Muktzeh Machmat
Mi'us which prohibits ugly or dirty
objects.

Höchster nods.

KISSINGER (cont'd)
Zum Beispiel...

For example...

Another student interjects.

MEYER
... dein Sporthemd nach zwei Minuten
Übungen.

... your sports shirt after two
minutes of exercise.

Supressed laughter can be heard from the whole group. Even the serious Höchster smiles for a moment.

INT. FÜRTH, KISSINGER HOME: LIVING ROOM - AFTERNOON

A door opens. Paula Kissinger holds a bag with black bread, a letter and the latest Fürther Nachrichten in her hands. She walks past her husband Louis who almost seems invisible with his green shirt against the green armchair. He has a prominent jaw and a faint mustache, hiding behind his reading glasses. With his stoic expression, taking notes in a Handelswissenschaften course book, he actively pretends not to notice her.

On her way to the kitchen she stops and drops the newspaper and letter on the large living room table with a certain power to make sure the landing cannot be overheard. Yet her husband overhears it.

In the corner of the room, and upright piano gathers dust. The collection of records behind it, most noticeably Mahler, complement the vast book collection the the living room.

Louis' hands cross out certain text passages in the book while circling others.

In loud steps Paula flees into the kitchen...

INT. FÜRTH, KISSINGER HOME: KITCHEN - AFTERNOON

... lays the bread on the cutting board and turns on the radio. A German Requiem by Brahms chimes. Just after she takes a knife, the music fades out and is replaced an emphatic news anchor about Germany's rearmament efforts and the threat from other European countries. She cuts the bread aggressively.

INT. FÜRTH, JEWISH SCHOOL - AFTERNOON

As it starts to rain, Höchster closes the window next to him.

HÖCHSTER

Ich wurde neulich über die
Veröffentlichung eines Bericht
informiert welcher für in dieser
Runde für reichlich Gesprächsstoff
sorgen sollte. Ein Bericht der Royal
Commission in England unter Earl Peel
...

I was recently informed about the
publication of a report that should
provide plenty of food for thought in
this circle. A report from the Royal
Commission in England under Earl
Peel...

The Torah Student from before cannot help whispering another remark to his seatmates.

MEYER

Ich habe nur von Earl Grey gehört...
er sollte guten Tee machen.

I've only heard of Earl Grey... who
supposedly makes good tea.

Suppressed laughter can be heard. Now even by the teacher. He walks towards him intimidatingly.

HÖCHSTER

Ruhe jetzt Meyer!

HÖCHSTER (cont'd)

Quiet now, Meyer!

MEYER

Entschuldige... ich meine
entschuldigen Sie Herr Höchster.

Excuse me... I mean, excuse me,
Mister Höchster.

Quickly shifting the attention back to the whole class the
young teacher continues.

HÖCHSTER

... jedenfalls geht es in diesem,
bald veröffentlichten Bericht um die
Teilung Palästinas in einen jüdischen
und einen arabischen Staat da dort,
wie ihr wisst, reichlich Konflikt
zwischen den Völkern herrscht.

... anyway, this soon-to-be-published
report is about the partition of
Palestine into a Jewish and an Arab
state, since, as you know, there is a
lot of conflict between the peoples
there.

LION

Aber würde die Teilung des Staates
und die Zuflucht von mehr Juden nicht
zu noch mehr Konflikten führen?

But wouldn't dividing the state and
allowing more Jews to seek refuge
lead to even more conflict?

TORAH STUDENT

Ich halte dies für naheliegend. Die
Britten sollten sich mit ihren
Ambitionen zurücknehmen. Es reicht
doch wenn wir hier in Deutschland
verhasst sind.

I think this is obvious. The British
should tone down their ambitions.
It's enough that we're hated here in
Germany.

The last remark doesn't produce the intended laughter but
instead silence.

HÖCHSTER

Was meinen Sie Kissinger?

(MORE)

HÖCHSTER (cont'd)

What do you think, Kissinger?

Not expecting to be called upon, Kissinger clears his throat and adjusts his glasses. Because he has not prepared anything, his slight nervousness comes through at first.

KISSINGER

Nun ich denke... wieso werfen wir den Blick in so weit entfernte Länder. Wir sollten unsere Zukunft hier aufbauen wie es auch unsere Eltern und Großeltern gemacht haben. Unsere Kultur ist mehr als die Jüdische. Wir sind deutsche Juden. Zwei Seiten derselben Münze. Dies kann uns niemand nehmen.

Well, I think... why do we look to such distant lands? We should build our future here, just as our parents and grandparents did. Our culture is more than Jewish. We are German Jews. Two sides of the same coin. No one can take that away from us.

HÖCHSTER

Wer stimmt Kissinger zu?

Who agrees with Kissinger?

The whole class raises their hand.

INT. FÜRTH, KISSINGER HOME - AFTERNOON

Paula returns to the table with some slices of the Pre-Abendbrot. It is spread with Liptauer, cheese and ham.

PAULA

Karl hat Dir geschrieben.

Karl wrote to you.

LOUIS

(places glasses on table)

Wie geht es ihm?

How is he doing?

PAULA

(annoyed)

Denkst du ich lese deine Briefe?

(MORE)

PAULA (cont'd)

Do you think I read your letters?

She takes the letter from the magazine and puts it in front of him.

The camera moves closer to the paper as Louis opens it reluctantly. The address is Palestine.

LOUIS

Hoffentlich brauchen die Araber auch Schuhe und rennen nicht barfuß herum.

Hopefully the Arabs also need shoes and don't run around barefoot.

PAULA

(attempting self-reassurance)

Es wird ihm doch gut gehen... oder?

He'll be fine... right?

LOUIS

Im Vergleich zu Fürth, nein. Ganz bestimmt nicht. Aber im Vergleich zu Dachau...

Compared to Fürth, no. Definitely not. But compared to Dachau...

His face freezes for a second.

PAULA

Wir sollten auch wegziehen.

We should also move away.

LOUIS

Das kommt ganz und gar nicht infrage. Ihr habt ja alle leicht reden. Ich jedoch bin zehn Jahre älter als mein Bruder und habe mein... unser Leben hier aufgebaut. Sobald ein Baum einmal Wurzeln schlägt kann man ihn nicht mehr umtopfen wie eine kleine Pflanze.

That's completely out of the question. It's easy for all of you to say that. But I'm ten years older than my brother and I've built my... our life here. Once a tree takes root, you can't repot it like a small plant.

PAULA
Leicht reden?

Easy for me?

She tries to grin sarcastically while her eyes turn watery.

PAULA (cont'd)
Denkst du etwa für mich wäre das eine
leichte Entscheidung? Denkst du etwa
nichts hält mich an diesem Ort?

Do you think this would be an easy
decision for me? Do you think nothing
keeps me in this place?

She starts crying.

LOUIS
Was ist denn heute los mit dir?

What's wrong with you today?

PAULA
Vater hat Krebs...

Dad has cancer...

Louis stands up and pats her on the back softly.

LOUIS
Das... das ist erschütternd.

That... that is shocking.

She falls in his arms and cries in the green shirt.

PAULA
(voice damped)
Aber die Kinder brauchen eine
Zukunft.

But the children need a future.

LOUIS
Dann schick Heinz und Walter doch
über den Atlantik zu Sarah. Wir
bleiben hier. Ich werde weiter
unterrichten und du wirst...

Then send Heinz and Walter across the
Atlantic to Sarah. We'll stay here.
I'll continue teaching, and you'll...

She breaks away from him.

PAULA

Die Kinder brauchen einen Vater und eine Mutter. Lázár wird in diesem Jahr sterben und wir im Nächsten in diesem Hitlerstaat.

The children need a father and a mother. Lázár will die this year, and we will die next year in this Hitler state.

LOUIS

(laconic)

Dann soll es so sein.

So be it.

EXT. CAFÉ FINK - EVENING

A festive yet proletarian celebration is held by a dozen Nazi officials in celebration of the Beer Hall Putsch which occurred on the same day in 1923.

Swastikas, banners and improvised posters commemorating the fallen heroes can be seen across the room.

The chatter is silenced when a high official SS man stands up from his table.

OBERST REINBERGER

Es freut mich zu sehen, dass ihr in voller Zahl erschienen seit. Der Führer wäre stolz auf euch wie wir stolz sind auf den Mut unseres Führers den er vor 15 Jahren bewiesen hat.

I'm pleased to see that you turned out in full force. The Führer would be proud of you, just as we are proud of the courage our Führer demonstrated 15 years ago.

A teenager, the same age as Kissinger looks up to Reinberger trying to put on his most serious face and posture. Two other members of the Hitler Youth can be seen behind him.

OBERST REINBERGER (cont'd)
Heute ist ein feierlicher Tag. Daher
wurden wir beschenkt mit dem besten
Bier in ganz Bayern, von der
charmanten jungen Dame welche diesen
Laden schon alleine beherrscht.

Today is a special day. Therefore, we
were treated to the best beer in all
of Bavaria by the charming young lady
who runs this place all by herself.

The waitress smiles at Reinberger with two beers in hand.

OBERST REINBERGER (cont'd)
Mir ist nur leider gerade ihr Name
entfallen. Dies ist mir äußerst...

Unfortunately, I have just forgotten
her name. This is extremely...

Her face turns red.

MARGARETE
Oberst, mein Name ist Margarete.

Colonel, my name is Margarete.

OBERST REINBERGER
Ganz recht. Margarete. Die
bezaubernde Rose von Fürth. Doch
bevor ich wie Odysseus von den
Sirenenklängen, in meinem Fall dem
Alkohol, ganz beschwipst bin, lassen
sie mich fortfahren.

Quite right. Margarete. The
enchanted Rose of Fürth. But before
I get completely tipsy like Odysseus
from the sounds of the sirens, or in
my case, from alcohol, let me
continue.

Listeners smile at Reinberger. For a high Nazi official, he
has retained a charismatic approachability.

OBERST REINBERGER (cont'd)
Ja, heute ist ein feierlicher Tag.
Doch ist es auch ein Tag des
Gedenkens an die fünfzehn Gefallenen
welche beim Marsch auf die
Feldherrnhalle ihr Leben ließen. Herr
Schneider, dürfte ich Sie bitten...

(MORE)

OBERST REINBERGER (cont'd)

Yes, today is a solemn day. But it is also a day of remembrance for the fifteen fallen soldiers who lost their lives during the march to the Feldherrnhalle. Mister Schneider, may I ask you...

He points to another older Nazi member with less medals on display, possibly indicating a lower rank. He stands up and nervously opens a piece of paper.

SCHNEIDER

Bauriedl Andreas. Theodor Casella...

Oberst Reinberger takes a seat while the other names are read aloud. For a moment he pays attention and respect to the "martyrs" until his eyes glance at the distance. A member of the SS walks in big steps towards him.

Schneider looks at the SS man perplexed and waits for what he has to say. The man waves his hand, indicating he should continue his reading (which he does).

The SS man goes to Reinberger and whispers something in his ear for an unusually long time. Reinberger nods repeatedly.

SCHNEIDER (cont'd)

... Lorenz Ritter von Stransky und zu guter Letzt: Wilhelm Wolf.

... Lorenz Ritter von Stransky and last but not least: Wilhelm Wolf.

OBERST REINBERGER

Vielen Dank Herr Schneider. Bitte nehmen Sie Platz.

Thank you, Mister Schneider. Please take a seat.

Margarete takes the empty glasses from attendees who are now visibly drunk. Reinberger turns again to her.

OBERST REINBERGER (cont'd)

Oh und sie liebe Margarete...

Oh and dear Margarete...

MARGARETE

(nervous)

Noch ein Bier? Gewiss doch Herr...

Another beer? Certainly, sir...

OBERST REINBERGER

Nein!

No!

His tone is unusually harsh. The nervousness of her infects the room with restless anticipation of how the event will continue.

OBERST REINBERGER (cont'd)

Ich würde Sie bitten den Raum zu verlassen da wir etwas in eigener Sache besprechen müssen.

I would like to ask you to leave the room as we need to discuss something of our own.

She nods and turns towards the door quickly. However in the rush an (almost) empty glass is pushed from the table.

Time slows down as we watch the glass fall to the hardwood floor, shattering in hundreds of pieces and spilling beer on an officials leather boots...

EXT. NÜRNBERG SYNAGOGUE - EVENING

... more glass pieces keep dropping on the floor, creating something akin to a transparent anthill. As the camera moves out, we realise that these glasses were neither bottles nor drinking glasses but the windows of a synagogue.

EXT. CAFE FINK - EVENING

OBERST REINBERGER

Die teuflische Intention des jüdischen Volkes wurde erneut demonstriert. So erfuhr ich eben, dass unser Diplomat in Paris an den Schusswunden des Juden zugrunde ging. Soviel sei gewiss: dies ist kein Einzelfall sondern stellt denn natürlichen Zustand eines unmenschlichen Volkes da sofern man es toleriert. Daher frage ich in die Runde, sollen wir das Ermorden unserer Brüder tolerieren?

The diabolical intent of the Jewish people has been demonstrated once again.

(MORE)

OBERST REINBERGER (cont'd)
I just learned that our diplomat in
Paris died from the Jew's gunshot
wounds. One thing is certain: this is
not an isolated incident, but rather
the natural condition of an inhuman
people. If it is tolerated.
Therefore, I ask the group, should we
tolerate the murder of our brothers?

Like an explosion, a polyphonic "Nein!/No!" goes through the
room.

OBERST REINBERGER (cont'd)
Daher sieht Goebbels eine
Verschärfung der bisherigen Maßnahmen
vor. Und soviel sei gewiss: den
Ratten wird es nicht gefallen.

Therefore, Goebbels envisions a
tightening of the existing measures.
And one thing is certain: the rats
won't like it.

Excited cheers (although not as synchronous) are heard.

The SS official hands Reinberger a one page memo.

OBERST REINBERGER (cont'd)
Punkt Eins. Jüdische Häuser, Betriebe
und Synagogen sollen von nun an
zerstört werden.

Point One: Jewish homes, businesses,
and synagogues are to be destroyed
from now on.

EXT. NÜRNBERG SYNAGOGUE - NIGHT

A group of 45 SS and SA men walk towards the building. The
marching boots become more audible and shatter the silence.

Those, who have already arrived, throw lit torches through
the windows. We follow their shadows on the brick wall.

The fire of a torch is passed from one SS men to the next as
they walk in opposite directions around the building.

A dozen onlookers also enter the scene and watch the
"spectacle" with a mixture of curiosity and sadism.

INT. NÜRNBERG SYNAGOGUE - NIGHT

The large door of the synagogue blackens and begins to collapse. Through the open gap torches get thrown in.

One of them reaches the bench in the last row.

The spread of the flame is accelerated by Kerosine cans landing next to fires.

As the fire spreads throughout all interior elements, more of the grand building can be seen.

On the eastern part, we move closer to the Torah ark. As its doors burn, one Torah scroll falls out and opens itself on the ground.

A Shamash light gets light. But instead of the candle wick, the wax from below burns only leaving the metal skeleton.

EXT. CAFE FINK - EVENING

OBERST REINBERGER

Punkt Zwei. Alle jüdischen Männer
sollen von der Polizei weggesperrt
werden, ihre Waffen konfisziert.

Point Two: All Jewish men should be
locked up by the police, and their
weapons confiscated.

EXT. NÜRNBERG SYNAGOGUE - NIGHT

Next to the mob of onlookers a middle aged Jewish rabbi stars at the fire in horror.

NUREMBERG BAKER (O.S.)

Hey! Da ist ein Jude!

Hey! There's a Jew!

Two men from the mob immediately approach him and grin.

The baker is reluctant to join and watches from a distance.

NUREMBERG TEACHER

Na was sagen Sie? Jetzt ist es wohl
zu spät zu beten, nicht wahr?

Well, what do you say? It's probably
too late to pray now, isn't it?

The other man pushes the Jew to the ground and puts his hand around his throat.

NUREMBERG FARMER

Ich denke wir brauchen etwas Feuriges
für unseren Gast!

I think we need something fiery for
our guest!

An SS men joins them. He opens his can of gasoline and spills it over the Jews head.

The victim breaths heavily. First with his mouth, but as the Gasoline runs down the face, he closes his eyes and tries breathing with his nose.

The farmer loosens his throat grip.

NUREMBERG FARMER (cont'd)

(threatening)

Denk nicht daran zu fliehen hörst Du?

Don't think about running away, do
you hear?

The Jewish man nods reluctantly.

Almost all onlookers have turned their attention from the synagogue towards the first victim of the Night of Broken Glass.

NUREMBERG FARMER (cont'd)

(turns to audience)

Wir veranstalten hier ein
physikalisches Experiment.

We are conducting a physics
experiment here.

The farmer takes out a match.

NUREMBERG FARMER (cont'd)

Wie schnell denkt ihr, kann ein
Judenkörper zu Asche werden?

How quickly do you think a Jewish
body can turn to ash?

He lights the match with his shoe, takes the can from the SS man to spread the liquid across the body.

NUREMBERG FARMER (cont'd)

Nun, finden wir es heraus.

(MORE)

NUREMBERG FARMER (cont'd)

Well, let's find out.

The audience is completely silent. A young girl watches with bright eyes but her father closes them with his hands.

A loud sound can be heard from the synagogue, possibly a part of the wall crumbling.

The match falls in slow motion to the ground, a few centimeters away from the victims shoes.

It lands and immediately catches fire. But only for a second.

A black boot extinguishes the flame. It belongs to another SA official. The shoe keeps burning until he stomps it a few times in the ground.

NUREMBERG SA MAN

Nicht so hastig meine Herrschaften.

Not so hasty, gentlemen.

He turns to the Jew.

NUREMBERG SA MAN (cont'd)

Ein toter Jude kann uns keine Informationen liefern.

A dead Jew cannot provide us with any information.

The Jew looks perplexed.

NUREMBERG SA MAN (cont'd)

Na komm. Stehen sie auf.

Come on. Stand up.

Very slowly to victim gets up from the ground. His hands and feet shaking.

The SA man grabs the back of the man's jacket to "present" him to the audience.

NUREMBERG SA MAN (cont'd)

Ich schlage vor wir machen einen nächtlichen Spaziergang zu den Kollegen dieses Herren.

I suggest we take a nighttime stroll to this gentleman's colleagues.

The audience shouts in agreement.

The SA man whispers something into the ear of the SS man who takes out a paper. He hands the paper to the SS man.

NUREMBERG SA MAN (cont'd)
Wo befindet sich zum Beispiel ihr
Kollege... Samuel Goldstein?

Where, for example, is your
colleague... Samuel Goldstein?

The Jew doesn't say anything. The SA Man gives a sign to his colleague who hits the Jew in the stomach.

NUREMBERG SA MAN (cont'd)
Erinnern sie sich jetzt vielleicht?

Do you perhaps remember now?

NUREMBERG JEW
Ich weiß es nicht.

I don't know it.

Another hit follows. The Jewish man throws up.

NUREMBERG SPECTATOR
Herr Goldstein wohnt in der
Königstraße. 29 glaube ich.

Mister Goldstein lives at Königstraße
29, I believe.

NUREMBERG SA MAN
Na also. Dann staten wir ihm einen
Besuch ab.

Well then, let's pay him a visit.

INT. STERN HOUSE - DAY

Henry, Walter and Louis stand in front of an old wheelchair in which a feeble old man is sunken in.

Paula is exchanging an emotional farewell to her father. She holds his hands and starts sobbing.

Henry glances towards the window. A blackbird lands on the tree branch. His unaffected, free attitude offers a temporary escape to the boy. The bird flies away.

PAULA
(whispering)
Heinz...

She touches her son's shoulder.

He walks slowly towards his grandfather.

The old man blinks several times to make his vision better.

GRANDFATHER

Heinz bist du das?

Heinz is that you?

KISSINGER

Ja Großvater.

Yes, grandfather.

Henry wants to say something but doesn't find anything appropriate for this final encounter.

Surprisingly, the grandfather straightens from his sunken position. A smile emerges on his face.

GRANDFATHER

Keine Sorge Heinz. Bevor ihr von
dannem zieht, werde ich euch noch ein
letztes Mal Zuhause besuchen.

Don't worry, Heinz. Before you leave,
I'll visit you at home one last time.

Henry nods, mostly to reassure himself.

EXT. FÜRTH, SCHULHOF - NIGHT

The silence of the night is disturbed by the breaking of iron gates at Schulhof.

The full moon over Fürth gives the scene a dreamy light.

150 SA men run through it and make their way towards the synagogue.

INT. NEUBURGER HOUSE - NIGHT

We fly through a room whose highlight is a stack of books on the bedside table. The glasses appear to be Kissinger's.

Someone is sleeping in the bed.

The camera stays for a few seconds on the door.

The door burst open with a loud kick. It pops against the wall.

Albert Neuburger opens his eyes as if he awoke from a nightmare. He slowly reaches for the light switch of the lamp to his left.

As the light turns on, two men in Nazi uniforms can be seen. Neuburger gasps.

One man grabs his feet and brutally drags him out of the bed. Neuburger's hands hit the book tower that falls down.

INT. FÜRTH, SYNAGOGUE - NIGHT

After opening the main entrance, 50 men start breaking down pews and ornaments.

Systematically, they pile up Torah scrolls in the middle of the building and douse them with petrol.

A man with a torch gives the others a sign to leave the synagogue.

He sets the pile on fire and quickly walks out.

EXT. FÜRTH, WELFARE OFFICE - NIGHT

The taller Nazi drags Neuburger over the hard pavement as the other man tries to open the door of the Jewish Welfare Office.

FÜRTH NAZI 1
Geschlossen.

Closed.

FÜRTH NAZI 2
Nun, da hätte ich eine Idee...

Well, I got an idea...

He looks down to Neuburger who has given up resisting.

Now both men carry him like a battering ram, one holding the feet, the other the torso.

Neuburger's head smashes into the door.

The men repeat this procedure several times until it opens and throw the unconscious men on the ground.

They enter the building.

Blood runs down from Neuburgers face and fills the pavement. The red liquid...

EXT. ATLANTIC OCEAN, S.S. HANSA - DAY

... turns into blue water.

Paula and Louis look back on the endless ocean feeling both relieved but also longing for what once was.

Henry and Walter play tag at the front of the ship. When it is Walter's turn, he freezes.

KISSINGER

Na komm her Walter. Fang mich!

Come here, Walter. Catch me!

Kissinger jumps back and forth and reaches out his hand so that it would be easier to catch.

Walter doesn't move, instead his eyes widen.

Now Heinz has to turn his head to see what is so mesmerizing.

But there seems to be nothing, only blue ocean.

KISSINGER (cont'd)

Was ist denn los?

What's going on?

WALTER

Schau genau hin Heinz.

Look closely, Heinz.

Walter points his hand. The coastline of New York can be seen in the distance, slowly the first skyscrapers start to appear.

KISSINGER

Land!

WALTER

Und nicht nur irgendein Land...

(MORE)

WALTER (cont'd)
And not just any country...

KISSINGER
... Amerika.
... America

EXT. NEW YORK CITY, MANHATTAN'S WEST 185TH STREET - MORNING

Heinz is overwhelmed by the architecture of the city. He passes a small cinema and glances at the posters: The Adventures of Robin Hood starring Errol Flynn and Disney's Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs. The last poster catches his attention: Accidents Will Happen. He reads the actors name.

KISSINGER
Ronald Reagan.

His imaginary excursion into Hollywood, and the ice cream parlor that was to be his destination is interrupted by footsteps. A few meters away a group of a dozen schoolchildren come his way.

Kissinger immediately walks towards the other side of the road. Realizing where he was he stands still and adjusts his glasses.

A Ford car humps.

DRIVER
Hey boy. Look at the street next time
okay?

Kissinger goes back to the other side and looks at the children who pay no attention to him.

Assured, that they are not a threat, Kissinger smiles and continues his walk to the parlor where he is greeted by a smiling woman behind the counter.

INT. NEW YORK CITY, KISSINGER LIVING ROOM - EVENING

A double couch in the center of the tiny room functions as the bed for Heinz and Walter. While the brother plays around with a new radio trying to find a station with music, Heinz goes to the kitchen, the only space for homework.

We get a view of the setting sun over Washington Heights from the kitchen window.

Heinz is in the process of writing a letter to his former friends. Although written in German, Henry's thinking is now in English.

EXT. NEW YORK CITY, EMPIRE STATE BUILDING - MORNING

Kissinger is staring at the Empire State building. His friend Walter Oppenheim is eating peanuts and talks to him.

 KISSINGER (V.O.)
You need to have been to the
skyscraper area of New York to
understand what modern technology can
create...

EXT. NEW YORK CITY, VARIOUS STREETS - DAY

We see a Chevrolet that has difficulty making a left turn. It slides on the icy street and almost crashes into a parked car.

Kissinger, the driver looks into the backwards mirror timidly.

The driving instructor has a stern look on his face.

While driving, the seasons change from winter to spring, with the leaves on the trees in central park magically appearing (alongside playing children). The same Chevrolet is driving next to the park. An emergency braking because of an overlooked pedestrian with a dog leads to the instructor (now with a beard) shaking his head.

On another rainy day, Kissinger looks a little more confident behind the wheel. A different driving instructor is impressed by his skills. He nods after his student manages to park the car in a narrow and dense alley.

Freed from the oversight of anyone, Kissinger speeds up the car and drives with his friend John Sachs outside of the city...

EXT. HUDSON PARKWAY - DAY

... and onto the highway to observe the scenery.

 KISSINGER (V.O.)
You need to have driven on an
American highway into the countryside
to be able to understand the
exaggerated patriotism of Americans.

Farmers can be seen who have an American flag on their houses.

EXT. NEW YORK CITY, FIFTH AVENUE - EVENING

Kissinger walks past the stores and restaurants of this famous street. Because of a wind, the street is surprisingly empty.

KISSINGER (V.O.)
But the greater the light, the
greater the shadow sides are.

He sees a beggar on the streets who holds onto his cardboard box which resembles a tiny house. Kissinger looks at him pitiful. The beggar gets out of focus as we see upper class New Yorkers dining 5 meters behind him.

KISSINGER (V.O.) (cont'd)
Alongside the most beautiful houses
in the world you see here the most
wretched, alongside excessive wealth,
unspeakable poverty.

Some people leave the restaurant in loud chatter as Kissinger continues his walk. The beggar disappears in the night.

INT. NEW YORK CITY, EDITH PERITZ BALLROOM - NIGHT

A group of 15 young men stand opposite 15 young women. They stare at each other waiting.

The instructor Edith Peritz walks into the middle of the room.

EDITH PERITZ
Now each gentleman may approach a
dance partner.

Lost in thoughts Kissinger moves to the opposite side after the other men have already began walking and pushing each other around.

KISSINGER (V.O.)
And then this individualism! You
stand completely on your own, no one
cares about you, you have to make
your own way upwards.

The safest way is to go in a straight line but after the first few steps Kissinger bumps into a two meter tall colleague. In the near distance a dark haired woman smiles at him. He walks in quick steps towards her.

EDITH PERITZ

We greet the partner with a hand
kiss.

Kissinger reaches for the girls hand and pulls it up slowly. He closes his eyes during the kiss.

ANNE FLEISCHER (O.S.)

Hello sir. What's your name?

KISSINGER

Heinz... I mean Henry. Great to meet
you Miss...

ANNE FLEISCHER

Anneliese. I mean Anne.

They both laugh, but quickly stifle it, mindful of the formal setting of the dance school.

KISSINGER

You're also from Germany? I didn't
notice your accent.

ANNE FLEISCHER

Well I noticed yours.

EDITH PERITZ

Now that everyone has formed a pair,
let's begin with the class. Please
form a circle with your partner.

The whole group slowly forms a circle.

KISSINGER

(lowered voice)

Where are you from Anne?

Anne's face turns serious, remembering her past.

ANNE FLEISCHER

Nuremberg.

An older dance instructor grabs Edith.

EDITH PERITZ

Today we will learn the waltz. Music
please!

A hand places the record needle on the phonograph in the corner and starts it. Classical music begins playing as Edith and her partner dance around the students.

EDITH PERITZ (cont'd)
One and Two! One and Two! One...

INT. NEW YORK CITY, KISSINGER LIVING ROOM - DAY

Kissinger takes notes while studying a book from the City College library. Anne silently enters the room and touches him on his shoulders.

A half eaten birthday cake with a sugary 19 is also on the table.

ANNE FLEISCHER
So what's your plan for after college? You can't be reading your whole life.

Kissinger takes off his glasses and taps on the book.

KISSINGER
I guess accounting would be a nice job. Not exactly my calling...

ANNE FLEISCHER
But what is your calling?

KISSINGER
Let's talk on my next birthday.

Anne sighs playfully and goes back to the living room. Kissinger takes a piece of the cake and eats it with his fingers. A few crumbs fall on his notebook. He pushes them off the table.

ANNE FLEISCHER (O.S.)
Henry. Did you see this letter?

Kissinger turns toward Anne although she still isn't in view.

KISSINGER
What letter?

He licks his fingers.

Anne comes back to the kitchen with the letter in her shaking hand.

ANNE FLEISCHER

It is... it is from the draft board.

Kissinger smirks...

KISSINGER

Well in that case...

... and closes the notebook.

KISSINGER (cont'd)

... my calling can wait.

EXT. CAMP CROFT, TRAINING FACILITY - DAY

Kissinger, now with millimeter short hair is running. At first we don't know from or to what, until we see the instructor yelling repeatedly at those who fall behind.

A jam is building up at the obstacle course in front of him. Trying to pass his comrades he jumps between different wooden poles instead of sticking to the straight route. But his intellectual advantage doesn't match his athleticism.

Breathing heavily, he climbs up a cargo net. Approaching the top he decides to rest for a few seconds. Kissinger watches different men marching in the distance and hears the shouting of their instructors. A wind breeze offers a slight relief from the summer heat.

Behind and in front of him, the recruits pass by. It is as if he was invisible.

Kissinger realizes that his lieutenant is walking towards him.

KISSINGER

Oh shit.

With difficulty he climbs and pulls his feet over the top net. On his way down he almost falls.

Looking through the net into the camera, we realize that he is missing something: his glasses.

From his point of view we see how the whole world has gotten blurry. The passing recruits now look like shadow figures while only the colors of Camp Croft can be identified. With shaking feet and hands, the upcoming WW2 veteran tries to make his way down.

But he slips and falls into the dirt.

LIEUTENANT

Hey kiddo. Don't you pull that of
with the Japs. They won't wait to
shoot ya.

Kissinger gets up from the ground grabbing the net.

KISSINGER

(false military
bravado)

Excuse me sir!

Five other men run by perplexed, some laughing.

The lieutenant leans forward, appearing more threatening and
approachable at the same time.

LIEUTENANT

You miss anything?

With a firm "handshake" the lieutenant give Kissinger his
glasses.

KISSINGER

Thank you sir!

Kissinger continues his run. After some easy terrain the
circle goes back to the obstacle course.

INT. CAMP CROFT, BARRACK - NIGHT

Kissinger lies in his bed looking at his comrades for a
brief moment before returning to "The Decline of the West"
by Oswald Spengler. They sit on the floor and play an
intense round of poker. One of them waves his hands as if to
say "join us."

CAMP CROFT COMRADE

Hey Henry.

Another comrade whistles.

Kissinger, fully immersed in the book seems to be arguing
with the author. His fingers are pressed on the page.

KISSINGER

Bullshit... if decline is inevitable,
inaction is the only option. The 20th
century isn't written yet and
individuals have the ability to
change history.

His comrade does a looney gesture and whistles. Kissinger notices.

KISSINGER (cont'd)
Not these individuals.

INT. CAMP CROFT, AUDITORIUM - DAY

An American flag hanging on the wall is waving a bit (probably because of the opened windows and the stormy weather outside).

With slightly longer hair, Kissinger stands in front of his comrades. A representative from the INS (Immigration and Naturalization Services) is standing next to him.

Kissinger raises his right hand.

KISSINGER
I hereby declare that I absolutely and entirely renounce and abjure all allegiance and fidelity to any foreign prince, potentate, state, or sovereignty, and particularly to Germany, of whom I have heretofore been subject.

The importance of the oath for Kissinger is contrasted with the complete disinterest the representative shows.

KISSINGER (cont'd)
I will support and defend the Constitution and laws of the United States of America against all enemies, foreign and domestic; that I will bear true faith and allegiance to the same; and that I take this obligation freely without any mental reservation or purpose of evasion.

The flag is now waving in affirmation.

KISSINGER (O.S.)
So help me God.

EXT. CAMP CLAIBORNE, RIFLE RANGE - DAY

A group of 15 exhausted men, including Kissinger walk to the grass field next to the camp. Because of the heat (and the 16 kilometer walk before) they "drop" down, one after the other. Some drink water from metal cans.

A cloud of dust is coming towards them. It is caused by a jeep. One man, Lieutenant Paul looks baffled.

The car stops and the door opens as the whole group observe this rare visit.

We follow two riding boots and a walking stick, elegantly moving over the grass, careful to not step into any soil that might make them dirty. The camera goes upwards, revealing Jodhpurs trousers and the Jewish face of Fritz Kramer whose eccentricity is further emphasized by a 19th century monocle on his left eye.

His face has a stern look as he approaches a resting private

FRITZ KRAEMER
Who's in command here?

Another man raises his hand startled.

LIEUTENANT PAUL
Me sir!

Kraemer moves his eyes to the lieutenant before moving his head. He tilts his head slightly.

FRITZ KRAEMER
Sir. I've been sent by the general
and I'm going to speak to your
company about why we are in this war.

LIEUTENANT PAUL
Understood. What is your name
captain?

FRITZ KRAEMER
Captain?

Kraemer starts laughing.

FRITZ KRAEMER (cont'd)
I'm a private so technically you are
above me. But technicalities are not
what decides victories.

His experience in public speaking has drawn in the rest of the men.

FRITZ KRAEMER (cont'd)
You wanna know what does?

INT. CAMP CLAIBORNE, BASE THEATRE - EVENING (SUMMER 1944)

The 15 men are now joined by another 50 including Kissinger who is transfixed by the passionate speaker.

FRITZ KRAEMER

A tank every 30 minutes, an aircraft every 15 minutes, and a truck every 7 minutes. Gentlemen if I tell you that we have the greatest industrial machine in the history of this world would anyone disagree?

No chatter or responses are heard.

FRITZ KRAEMER (cont'd)

And if I tell you that we have the best democracy since our founding fathers wrote the Declaration of Independence, would anyone disagree?

Now a few listeners shout out a "No!"

FRITZ KRAEMER (cont'd)

(whispers)

But I wanna let you in on a secret.

He walks close to the first row, seemingly addressing each man individually.

FRITZ KRAEMER (cont'd)

Thousands of the most modern tanks will be of no use for the defense of a country, if the men in there are unwilling to fight, and here I say it, to die for the cause.

The best laws, the most progressive legislation, are not worth their paper, if the moral qualities of those who have to apply them are doubtful.

We are here because we don't doubt our purpose. Because the outcome of this war will determine the rest of history.

Kraemers speech continues but we can only see his energetic gestures.

An older Kissinger can be heard as the young one nods in agreement.

KISSINGER (V.O.)

For the first and perhaps the only time, I wrote to a speaker to say how much he moved me. Out of this grew a relationship that changed my life.

INT. CAMP CLAIBORNE, HALL - NIGHT

The Enlisted Men's Club takes place in this modestly decorated room. Its highlights include a pool table and a jukebox that plays Big Band tunes. A few privates dance with their "buddies".

Kraemer sips an espresso while Kissinger opens his Coca-Cola.

FRITZ KRAEMER

So Henry, I suspect you are from Bavaria.

KISSINGER

Yess, Fürth. But how did you know?

Kraemer points to his mouth. Kissinger nods embarrassed.

FRITZ KRAEMER

We could continue in German if you like.

Kissinger shakes his head.

KISSINGER

No, English is...

FRITZ KRAEMER

Ou en français, in italiano, en español, ou em português.

KISSINGER

How do you know all of those languages?

Kraemer leans forward.

FRITZ KRAEMER

I come around a lot.

One amateur dancer who took on the woman's role had difficulty stepping backwards.

FRITZ KRAEMER (cont'd)

Now what are your views...

KISSINGER

On this war?

Kraemer nods.

KISSINGER (cont'd)

I assess that the Axis powers are nearing collapse, we stand at the outset of a far more complex challenge: forging an international order to prevent future aggression.

FRITZ KRAEMER

And how should the president or commoners like ourselves achieve this, provided we defeat Hitler?

KISSINGER

Ahm. Well. I propose some sort of security framework grounded in a vision for world peace. Similar to the League of Nations but without the flaws that led to the present situation.

Kissinger continues talking while we see Kraemer thinking about his, soon-to-be protégé.

FRITZ KRAEMER (V.O.)

As yet he knows nothing.

Kraemer takes another sip from the coffee.

FRITZ KRAEMER (V.O.) (cont'd)

But already he understands everything.

The music of the Jukebox is replaced by battle noises coming from inconspicuous sources.

The kettle in the kitchen sounds like muffled explosions while the dancers footsteps snap into a sudden synchronized march.

FRITZ KRAEMER (V.O.) (cont'd)

This young man Kissinger seems to have an inner ear for the music of history.

The hands of the damaged clock send off a hectic moursecode with each irregular movement. The sound gets louder and louder.

The battle noises suddenly stop and the Jukebox isn't playing anymore. Indeed Kraemer and Kissinger are the only ones left in this darkened room. Their glasses are empty.

KISSINGER
Concerning our training, do you have any information on our location of deployment?

Kraemer doesn't move which translates to "I don't know."

KISSINGER (cont'd)
Rumour has it that it will be either China, India or Burma.

FRITZ KRAEMER
Don't trust rumours. Trust your heart, trust your eyes Henry.

Pointing to his eye, Kraemer takes off the monocle and lays it casually on the table.

FRITZ KRAEMER (cont'd)
Do you know why I am wearing this?

KISSINGER
Obviously to improve your vision sir. Like myself.

Kissinger taps his glasses.

FRITZ KRAEMER
And how do I improve my vision?

Kissinger laughs nervously assuming it is a trick question.

KISSINGER
Well. By getting a prescription from an eye doctor and then putting the lens in front of the weak eye.

FRITZ KRAEMER
And how long would I have to do this?

KISSINGER
I'm afraid until the end of your days. Unless they invent some drug in the future.

FRITZ KRAEMER
So my weak eye won't get stronger.

KISSINGER
No sir.

Kraemer snaps his finger and leans forward.

FRITZ KRAEMER
That's conventional thinking my
friend. You see...

Kraemer puts back the monocle and points to his right eye.

FRITZ KRAEMER (cont'd)
This is my weak eye. It has to catch
up with my American eagle eye. We
don't achieve greatness without the
pressures others put onto us. This
war is one test of our vision as free
men.

KISSINGER
And have you noticed any
improvements?

Kraemer tilts his head making a pokerface.

EXT. ATLANTIC OCEAN, VARIOUS - NIGHT

In the dark of the night, the USS Arizona makes its way
across the vastness of the sea. Some privates can be seen
chatting on board of the deck, most of them smoking.

The view flies underwater towards a German submarine just a
few hundred meters away from the ship. It launches a
torpedo.

A deep thunderous boom and an explosion below the waterline
make the passengers unsteady. They drop their cigarettes and
walk quickly across the deck to investigate it.

A second submarine comes forth behind the first and fires
another torpedo.

The ship tilts to one side as seawater floods in and more
explosions destroy the structure.

As the alarm goes off, people run out of their quarters,
bumping into each other, some even falling overboard.

The camera zooms in on a young private. He doesn't move but
instead holds onto his cross necklace.

SHIP PASSENGER
(nervous)
Please god. Don't let me die here.
Don't let me die here.

He falls over with the ship and a dozen passengers but still manages to hold onto a metal pipe.

Because of the oil spillage the water below burns with people shouting out their last screams.

The young man finally hits the water as the ship turns over.

Big waves and a glowing fire can be seen 500 meters away.

EXT. ATLANTIC OCEAN, STIRLING CASTLE - MORNING

The first sunlight hits Kissinger's face who immediately lifts himself up. Feeling seasick he walks out of his quarter towards the front of the ship.

The ship looks almost identical to USS Arizona. The camera flies over the ocean and follows an elongated shadow right under the surface. A dolphin jumps out of the water.

Kissinger smiles at the sight as other privates start going on their morning walk.

EXT. GERMANY, VARIOUS - DAY

The G-2 section of which Kissinger is part of, marches through the muddy streets of a German town. Tracks of tanks can be seen but no civilians. Almost all of the houses are damaged or destroyed. Bombing can be heard in the distance.

One private taps another one on the back.

G-2 PRIVATE

Well I guess today's our lucky day.

He runs to a corner store whose front has been ripped open. With 5 other men, he raids the store. Some men immediately bite into the vegetables that are, surprisingly, still fresh.

Kissinger looks at a cardboard plane that serves as a window for a damaged house. The plane moves open and behind it is a young girl. She looks at Kissinger curiously before disappearing in the dark.

EXT. GERMANY, SMALL TOWN, RAILWAY STATION - EVENING

An abandoned railway station serves as the office for special agent Kissinger. On his desk at the ticket office, huge piles of documents and letters are sorted by the young private.

With a pencil he marks certain German phrases, takes notes on a separate sheet of paper and writes names onto the town map in front of him.

An assistant is doing the same task in the background while talking on the telephone that is connected to a switchboard by a wire.

G-2 ASSISTANT

... we're not sure if Frau Braun is an unreliable citizen. Her correspondence so far only concerned the meat business of her family... no she's not married...

Feeling tired, Kissinger takes a new sheet of paper and writes "Dear Walter".

KISSINGER (V.O.)

I am in much less danger over here than I will care to admit after the war. It is to be expected therefore, that your absent-minded and slightly myopic brother will be run over by a street car one day rather than killed in action.

The sound of tank shots in the distance only leads to a frown of the special agent.

INT. BELGIUM, MARCHE, SCHOOL BUILDING - NIGHT

In the crowded kitchen of an old school buildings cellar, two groups pass the time. They are made up of all age groups and backgrounds. American soldiers can be seen next to Belgian children running around.

The happy group plays spin the bottle. We get a view of the room spinning around as the camera is fixed on the object. It stays on a red haired Belgian girl which gets kissed by an excited teenager. The group claps.

The not-so-happy group in the corner seems to be engaged in a discussion. A woman, sitting next to her parents takes out a picture from her wallet. Kissinger looks at the pictures and taps Kraemer. She starts sobbing.

BELGIAN WOMAN

(speaking with an accent)

Lucas. He, he was shot by the Germans last month.

Kissinger is unsure how to guide this emotionally charged conversation.

KISSINGER

Did he work for the underground
forces?

The woman nods. Her father continues the conversation although he hasn't paid attention to what has been said.

OLD BELGIAN MAN

(even heavier accent)

These people... during the
occupation... I can't describe what
they did...

He tries to find his words through wild gestures.

Kissinger looks at the happy group who seem to have forgotten, at least momentarily, the impact of the war.

OLD BELGIAN MAN (cont'd)

They executed not just Lucas but also
our mayor...

The mother continues. If the widow represents sadness, the father confusion, then the mother stands for fear.

OLD BELGIAN WOMAN

(sharply)

Do you think they will be back again?

Kissinger looks at Kraemer. His facial expressions ask: should we tell the truth or what they want to hear?

FRITZ KRAEMER

Don't worry. We almost won the war.

The mother is relieved and does a silent prayer. She holds the fathers arm tight.

FRITZ KRAEMER (cont'd)

(to Kissinger)

Henry, I think our job is done for
today, why don't we have a little fun
for once.

The two walk towards the other group who is now dancing.

A loud explosion shatters all the windows. The dancers fall to the ground. As another bomb hits, the room lights up for a second and the whole cellar shakes.

The mother closes her eyes while the daughter remains lost in the past. Nobody in the room panics or screams, not even the young children.

AMERICAN SOLDIER

God damn it!

He stands up from the "dance floor".

AMERICAN SOLDIER (cont'd)

This one was close, can't be more
than 20 yards away.

Another man landed on his possible future wife. He continues the conversation from before as shells repeatedly fall every 30 seconds.

AMERICAN SOLDIER 2

Qu'est-ce que tu désires le plus chez
un homme?

What do you want most in a man?

FRENCH WOMAN

La tendresse.

Tendair-ness

The soldier smiles.

Kissinger stands in the middle of the room, feeling claustrophobic. He hides it under a slightly-less-false bravado.

KISSINGER

Does anyone want to go up with me?
See what's going on?

Another intellectual (indicated by his glasses and cerebral demeanor) steps towards him. He is also in uniform.

Kreamer shakes his head at the two men but doesn't say a word.

With confident steps they walk to the stairs...

EXT. BELGIUM, MARCHE, VARIOUS - NIGHT

... and into the dark of the night. As shells keep dropping.

The hands of the other intellectual shake visibly.

Kissinger breathes in the fresh air and tries to calm himself.

KISSINGER (V.O.)

Three-quarters of Allied soldiers killed in this war were the victims of artillery shells, mortars, grenades, or bombs. But on that night, I didn't want to await my faith...

INT. BELGIUM, MARCHE, SCHOOL BUILDING - NIGHT

Kraemer looks visibly worried about his student. The atmosphere is more tense now.

KISSINGER
... in what seemed like a prearranged
coffin.

We get a view of the whole room that does have resemblance to a coffin with the rounded corners and proportions.

EXT. BELGIUM, MARCHE, VARIOUS

The two men walk through the streets, past bombed buildings right next to the school. They pass by American officers who greet them casually and go on with their work.

At a train station other Americans continue typing without the slightest disturbance.

EXT. GERMANY, NEAR HANOVER - DAY

The division of which Kissinger is also part of march through the liberated and suburban territory next to Hanover.

A fellow GI Vernon Trott takes pictures of the destroyed buildings and occasionally a German citizen. Some are relieved to see the Americans while others try to dodge them (though unsuccessfully).

Through the viewfinder of Trotts camera, the viewer sees a 180 degree panorama of the scene.

However the movement stops at an unspectacular site.

No commercial buildings can be seen on the hillside. Only what appears to be a fence.

VERNON TROTT
(mumbling)
I think I found something.

EXT. GERMANY, AHLEM CONCENTRATION CAMP - DAY

The wired fence turns out to be electric. In addition to the sound of a few hundred volts a sign at the entrance read:
"Vorsicht! Hochspannung Lebensgefahr!/**Caution! High voltage, Life-Threatening!**"

Surprisingly, the gate is open. Kissinger is among the first to enter.

The bad smell of the place leads some GIs to cover their nose with a cloth handkerchief. The movement of the men in front stops and the bad smell fades into the background because of their next sight.

AMERICAN GI
Jesus Christ!

Vernon Trott pushes forward out of curiosity. Instead of taking pictures, he also freezes into a stare.

Piles of emaciated bodies lay on the ground, in trashcans and pits of the camp. Their slow unnatural movement resembles more that of an animal than a human.

In addition, dead bodies that are already rotting get eaten by flies and other insects.

All prisoners wear stripped shirts and pants. Their hair is cut short.

The photographer slowly steps forward almost falling over a 15 year old boy who is covered in his own vomit and urine. His face looks like that of a 40 year old men while his innocent eyes (that give away his age) stare into nothingness.

AMERICAN GI (cont'd)
We need food and water for these poor souls.

Kissinger goes in the direction of the barracks. On the stairs a middle aged man who seems more alive than the rest tries to assess the situation.

MOSHE MIEDZINSKY
British?

KISSINGER
American.

Kissinger bends down and looks the prisoner in the eyes.

KISSINGER (cont'd)
You are free.

A GI near the entrance cannot go further ahead after seeing the prisoners. He weeps silently while his colleagues enter the barracks.

INT. GERMANY, AHLEM CONCENTRATION CAMP, BARRACKS - DAY

The barracks are crammed with people, forcing the Americans to advance in goose-step. The floor is a mixture of dirt, human excretion and vomited food.

A GI pulls up a large bull whip from the floor.

Vernon Trott opens the door to a tiled room that is also filled with people. On the wall there are showerheads.

AMERICAN GI 2
Is that a bathroom?

Trott observes the ground.

VERNON TROTT
There are no drains. I know what this is.

He takes pictures of the showerheads.

EXT. GERMANY, AHLEM CONCENTRATION CAMP - DAY

Kissinger wanders around the concentration camp, trying to establish contact with the prisoners.

KISSINGER (V.O.)
That is humanity in the 20th century.
People reach such a stupor of
suffering that life and death,
animation or immobility can't be
differentiated anymore.

An American GI feeds a Jewish woman with a spoon of canned food. She has difficulty biting and swallowing it.

EXT. GERMANY, VARIOUS - DAY/NIGHT

The camera flies above the action and shows more of Germany with towns such as Krefeld that are colored red indicating Nazi occupation. Through a timelapse, more towns get captured by the blue Americans. The camera flies further out.

We hear the reporting of American radio stations on the advances contrasted by the passionate German propaganda. The occasional bombs still hit as we follow an aircraft flying over a city whose status is unclear because clouds hide the displayed information.

EXT. GERMANY, HANOVER, MUNICIPAL BUILDING - DAY

As the only car, a jeep is parked in front of the municipal building which has a damaged wall. American officers tear down the Nazi propaganda and hang up a poster consisting of only text (in German and English) asking for people with police experience to report to Sergeant Kissinger.

As the officers leave, a beefy man reads the poster and decides to enter.

INT. GERMANY, HANOVER, MUNICIPAL BUILDING - DAY

Three knocks on the office door indicate a visitor.

KISSINGER

Yess, please enter.

The new sergeant puts aside a stack of paper, marking where he should continue with a pen and stands up to greet the man.

KISSINGER (cont'd)

Guten Tag.

Good day.

GESTAPO MEMBER

Ich grüße Sie. Sie suchen Leute mit
Polizei erfahrung.

Greetings. You are looking for people
with police experience.

Kissinger nods.

GESTAPO MEMBER (cont'd)
Nun, ich war vier Jahre bei der
Staatspolizei.

Well, I was in the state police for
four years.

Kissinger suggests the man to sit down while going back to
his desk.

KISSINGER
(jokingly)
Geheime Staatspolizeit?

Secret state police?

GESTAPO MEMBER
In der Tat! Wollen Sie meine
Abzeichen sehen.

Indeed! Do you want to see my badges?

Kissingers suppresses his surprise.

KISSINGER
Vielen Dank. Nicht notwendig.

Thank you. Not necessary.

He stands up again, leading to a slight confusion with the
guest.

KISSINGER (cont'd)
Ich vergaß ihnen etwas zu trinken
anzubieten. Genügt ein Glas Wasser?

I forgot to offer you something to
drink. Will a glass of water suffice?

GESTAPO MEMBER
Natürlich.

Of course.

Kissinger leaves the room. The Gestapo member looks through
the paperwork on the desk.

The door opens again. Another sergeant accompanies
Kissinger. He holds out handcuffs.

Kissinger brings a glass of water to the shocked Gestapo
member. The man stands up and drinks it fast.

GESTAPO MEMBER (cont'd)
Wie... wie kann ich meine Gunst zum
Ausdruck bringen?

How... how can I express my goodwill?

KISSINGER
Helfen Sie uns ihre Kollegen zu
finden.

Help us find your colleagues.

EXT. GERMANY, GEILENKIRCHEN - DAY

Although no fighting is occurring here, there is a tense atmosphere. Possibly because of the windy conditions.

Kraemer hides behind a store front and observes an improvised training course. He chews and spits out a leave ball (which could have been used for dental hygiene).

Oberst Reinberger, now with battle scars, shows a 14 year old boy and an old man how to reload a pistol. The hands of the old man are shaking as he tries to perform the task.

Kraemer takes out his damaged notebook and sketches the Lieutenants face.

KRAEMER
(whispering)
I'll get you, you bastard.

The American is so focused on his investigative work that he doesn't notice a hand reaching to his shoulder.

AUGUST WEBER
(strong German accent)
Do you want to learn with them?

Kraemer keeps his cool.

KRAEMER
Oh ich weiß wie man schießt.

Oh I know how to shoot.

AUGUST WEBER
Doch nicht als Schütze...

But not as a shooter..

The man pulls Kraemer up aggressively.

AUGUST WEBER (cont'd)
Sondern als Zielscheibe.

But as a target.

Reinberger notices them.

OBERST REINBERGER
Schon wieder ein Amerikaner? Bevor
ihr in erschießt soll er noch von
seinen Kameraden erzählen.

Another American? Before you shoot
him, he should tell you about his
comrades.

Reinberger continues his training course.

The August Weber checks Kraemers pockets. There are no
weapons. He walks a few meters back and makes a beckoning
gesture.

AUGUST WEBER
Kommen sie mal mit.

Come along with me.

Kraemer follows him.

EXT. GERMANY, HANOVER - DAY

The Gestapo member is now handcuffed sitting in the back of
the jeep. Kissinger's colleague closes the door as they
slowly drive through the city.

KISSINGER
Wo sollen wir zuerst halt machen?

Where should we stop first?

GESTAPO MEMBER
Constantinstraße. Dort wohnt mein
Kollege August Spahn.

Constantinstraße. My colleague August
Spahn lives there.

Kissinger's colleague looks out the window.

AMERICAN SERGEANT
Hey Henry, that guy looks well fed.

Kissinger stops the car.

KISSINGER
(to the Gestapo
member)
Do you know... ich meine kenn Sie
diesen Mann?

Do you know this man?

The Gestapo member shakes his head.

Kissinger approaches the suspect.

KISSINGER (cont'd)
Guten Tag, wir sind die
amerikanischen Sergeants welche jetzt
die Administration dieser Stadt
übernehmen...

Good afternoon, we are the American
sergeants who are now taking over the
administration of this city...

AMERICAN SERGEANT
(in broken German)
... und wir suchen nach den last
Nazis.

... and we are looking for the last
Nazis.

KISSINGER
Wir wissen, dass sie nicht wichtig
sind und nur ein kleiner Fisch...

We know that you are unimportant and
just a small fish...

The suspect gets embarrassed, then turns aggressive.

SUSPECT
Ein kleiner Fisch? Sie reden hier mit
einem Kompanieführer ersten Rangs.
Ich habe für dieses Land...

A small fry? You're talking to a
company commander of the first rank.
I did everything for this country...

The man continues boasting about his war experience.

KISSINGER (V.O.)
I had the impression that the Gestapo
were all monsters...

The American sergeant shows the man the last free place in the jeep. He looks at the Gestapo member who nods and goes back to the car by himself.

The ride continues, this time with two informants.

KISSINGER (V.O.) (cont'd)
...In fact, they were mainly
miserable little bureaucrats who were
eager to work with us.

Kissinger looks into the rearview mirror watching the proud Germans spill out information.

EXT. GERMANY, GEILENKIRCHEN - DAY

Kraemer follows the Nazi across the Hauptstraße. Two lower ranked Nazis follow behind (whether for security or curiosity reasons is not clear). They stop at a white wall belonging to a building with a windowless facade..

AUGUST WEBER
Ohne deinem deutschen Akzent, wärst
du bloß ein regulärer
Kriegsgefangener der in der Zelle
hockt...

Without your German accent, you would
just be a regular prisoner of war
rotting in the cell...

Kraemer remains stoic.

AUGUST WEBER (cont'd)
... nun bist du jedoch ein Deserteur.
Für solche Fälle haben wir diese Wand
hier. (turns to young man) Wie
nanntest du Sie noch, Gustav?

But now you're a deserter. We have a
wall here for cases like that. (turns
to young man) What did you call it
again, Gustav?

GEILENKIRCHEN YOUNG NAZI
Die Wand der Verräter.

The Wall of Traitors.

AUGUST WEBER
Richtig. Die Wand der Verräter.
Würdest du bitte in Position gehen.

(MORE)

AUGUST WEBER (cont'd)

Right. Welcome to the Wall of
Traitors. Would you please get into
position.

The Nazi touches Kraemers shoulder in pleasurable sadism and points to the wall.

Kraemer goes towards it in slow steps.

He and the viewer notice hundreds of bullet holes on the surface.

Kraemer continues in even slower steps.

AUGUST WEBER (cont'd)

(jokingly to
assistants)

Die Vorstellung beginnt gleich.

The show starts soon.

The two young men stare at the captive destined for death.

The wind suddenly stops. A ray of light hits Kraemers head as he slowly turns around, eyes closed.

The Nazi loads his pistol.

Kraemer smiles.

KRAEMER

Ihr denkt also nach wie vor, dass ihr
diesen Krieg gewinnt?

So you still think you're going to
win this war?

AUGUST WEBER

Wie bitte?

Pardon?

KRAEMER

In den letzten 48 Stunden haben wir
12 Ortschaften erobert. In den
nächsten 12 Stunden wird auch diese
fallen.

In the last 48 hours, we've captured
12 towns. This one will fall in the
next 12 hours, too.

Without waiting for a response Kraemer clears his throat to continue in his standard loud voice.

KRAEMER (cont'd)

Denkt ihr meine Truppen werden euch Gnade erweisen wenn Sie von meinem Tod erfahren? Oder wenn Sie sehen wie ihr junge Burschen und alte Männer rekrutiert und in den Tod schickt.

Do you think my troops will show you any mercy when they hear of my death? Or when they see you recruiting young boys and old men and sending them to their deaths.

He points to the young assistants who look at each other and question their own fate through an expressive frown.

KRAEMER (cont'd)

Erschießt mich hier und jetzt! Nur zu! Aber sagt nicht, niemand hätte euch gewarnt.

Shoot me here and now! Go ahead! But don't say no one warned you.

The Nazi puts his pistol down and rubs the back of his head with the left hand.

Oberst Reinberger runs towards him.

OBERST REINBERGER

Wir haben amerikanische Panzer gesichtet. Zumindest fünf Stück. Müssen uns zum Angriff bereit machen.

We've spotted American tanks. At least five of them. We need to prepare for attack.

With a lost euphoria for battle the August Weber shakes his head.

AUGUST WEBER

Nein.

No.

He looks at the young men.

AUGUST WEBER (cont'd)

Wir müssen uns ergeben.

We must surrender.

Oberst Reinberger stares at him.

OBERST REINBERGER

Was?

What?

EXT. GERMANY, TANGERMÜNDE, RIVER ELBE - EVENING

Unaffected by the historical gravity of the end of WW2, the river Elbe keeps flowing, as always. At the riverbank German helmets are placed in the mud while a foot kicks one into the water.

A red army soldier with a scarred face walks past American Jeeps and Soviet Horses. More red army soldiers show up in the background. Instead of their strict march, the movement is meandering (with Vodka bottles being an indicator as to why).

A small soldier orchestra equipped with a Garmon and other traditional instruments begins a dance tune.

Lifting the hands to the air a man dressed in rural Soviet clothing claps to the beat. We only see his back.

Kissinger walks through the crowd in the direction of the orchestra. He gets offered Schnapps and Vodka but politely refuses.

Vernon Trott walks behind him, taking pictures.

VERNON TROTT

So Henry, where are you heading now
that the war's over?

Henry thinks while watching the squatting kick dance known as Prisyadka, performed in the mud.

VERNON TROTT (cont'd)

Stay in Europe, back to America?
Hell, I thought of doing a photo
series in the rainforest.

Vernon keeps shooting. Click. Click.

A red army soldier converses with the clapping man in Russian. As the camera moves around him, we see his face: Fritz Kramer.

The soldier begins to dance. Kramer drinks a shot of Vodka in one go, throws the bottle away and nods.

FRITZ KRAEMER

Da.

Kramer joins the dancers as the most energetic member. He keeps clapping and occasionally adjusting his monocle.

Kissinger sees his mentor in the distance.

VERNON TROTT

Henry are you deaf? Where are you going?

A ghost ship of German civilians and soldiers passes the Elbe. It is overladen with white sheets held by the passengers.

KISSINGER

Forward.

END OF BOOK 1.

BOOK 2: THE FIRE OF PROMETHEUS

Prometheus story Act 1. 1956

KISSINGER (V.O.)

For many centuries, the legend of Prometheus has been the symbol of the penalties of presumptuous ambition.

Prometheus story Act 2. Kissinger appears a few meters away from the punished god, walking closer to him and putting his hand on the gods head.

KISSINGER

It was not understood that the punishment inflicted on Prometheus was an act of compassion.

He turns to the camera.

KISSINGER (cont'd)

It would have been a much more severe penalty had the gods permitted their fire to be stolen.

EXT. NEW YORK CITY, VARIOUS STREETS - DAY - JUNE 1957

A Kissinger in his mid 30s is walking through New York City in summer and revisiting the places from his youth. He crosses the cinema which is now playing a Japanese Film: Godzilla. The poster shows a destroyed city with the monster wreaking havoc and civilians fleeing.

Kissinger leans in, his glasses are reflecting an atomic explosion. Possibly the one from the Nagasaki attacks.

 KISSINGER (V.O.)
Our generation has succeeded in
stealing the fire of the gods and it
is doomed to live with the horror of
its achievement.

A group of teenagers walk out of the cinema, engaged in an excited discussion.

Kissinger looks at his watch. His forehead wrinkles indicate that he has another meeting to attend soon. He walks at a faster pace past a newsstand until someone recognises him.

 NORMAN COUSINS
Dr. Kissinger. The Wise German from
Harvard.

Kissinger looks slightly annoyed, not knowing if the comment was meant to be flattery or a provocation.

They shake hands.

 KISSINGER
Sir Cousins. I recognise you...

The man at the newsstand doesn't recognise either. The displayed New York Times reads "On the Cult of Personality and Its Consequences" by Nikita Khrushchev.

 KISSINGER (cont'd)
... from the Sunday Review.

Cousins grabs a paper from the newsstand.

 NORMAN COUSINS
Very close.

It reads Saturday Review.

 KISSINGER
Well, I'm not much of a weekend
person.

The newsstand man holds out his hand, expecting Cousins to pay but he "throws" the paper back.

 NORMAN COUSINS
And you currently work for the
Council on Foreign Aggression?

KISSINGER

Precisely. In fact I have to be there
in 30 minutes.

Kissinger continues his fast walk. Cousins stays persistent.

NORMAN COUSINS

May I ask you a question Dr.
Kissinger?

KISSINGER

If it is not rhetorical.

NORMAN COUSINS

How exactly do you plan on solving
the nuclear issue?

KISSINGER

Neither through a World State nor the
World Peace Movement as your
communist friends would propose.

NORMAN COUSINS

I see. A proponent of the Great
Deterrent. But isn't it illusory to
expect aggressors from refraining its
use if, like that (snaps finger) the
other side is annihilated.

KISSINGER

Norman Cousins. I never said we
shouldn't use the bomb.

Norman Cousins looks as if Kissinger spoke in a foreign
language.

INT. NEW YORK CITY, COUNCIL ON FOREIGN RELATIONS, LIBRARY -
EVENING - JUNE 1957

Cigarette smoke from the audience fills this wood paneled
room. Among them are David Rockefeller, Gordon Dean,
McGeorge Bundy and Paul Nitze. The average attendance age
seems to be 65 (even considering the faster aging from the
time).

The "young" Kissinger stands in front of the lectern,
sorting through his paper notes. Next is a table displaying
his new book Nuclear Weapons and Foreign Policy.

KISSINGER

The free world is in crisis ladies
and gentlemen.

(MORE)

KISSINGER (cont'd)

With each Soviet advance president Eisenhower is faced with the choice of inaction or the empty threat of massive retaliation that neither the Soviets nor we believe to be credible. In other words the choice between impotence or annihilation. The administration lacks the tools for a flexible response.

Kissinger tries to read the room but the stone cold faces in the front row add to his nervousness.

KISSINGER (cont'd)

I propose a third option... Limited Nuclear War.

David Rockefeller skims through the book and stops at a page showing the range of different bombers on a world map.

KISSINGER (cont'd)

Nuclear weapons seem to offer the best opportunity to compensate for our inferiority in manpower and to use our superiority in technology to the best advantage. We won't have to fight another Korea.

He quickly turns his page.

KISSINGER (cont'd)

The goal of war can no longer be military victory. Instead it should be the attainment of certain political conditions which are fully understood by the opponent. With Limited Nuclear War we can inflict losses or pose risks on the Soviets that not even they can take.

A man from the audience stands up.

VETERAN

Sir, how do you plan on keeping these wars limited?

KISSINGER

We have to be very clear in conveying to the Soviets that we are capable of courses other than all-out war or inaction and that we intend on employing those.

VETERAN

And if they think it's a bluff so
they escalate before us?

KISSINGER

The greatest risk is not taking any
risks at all.

VETERAN

You sir are gambling with our
national survival!

The seat neighbor of the veteran makes a gesture that
translates to tone it down.

Kissinger leans forward...

INT. NEW YORK CITY, COUNCIL ON FOREIGN RELATIONS, DRAWING
ROOM - NIGHT - 1957

... to shake the hand of a new admirer.

DAVID ROCKEFELLER

Excellent presentation Dr. Kissinger.

Kissinger smiles.

KISSINGER

You're generous David. I suspect half
the room disagrees with me.

DAVID ROCKEFELLER

The other half will come around.

An older CFR member shakes Kissinger's hand. Their short
exchange is inaudible.

David seems slightly annoyed because Kissinger stands with
his back to him.

DAVID ROCKEFELLER (cont'd)

(raises voice)

Was my brother's input only of
monetary utility or could he guide
you through the project?

Kissinger thinks whether this is a trick question of his
indirect patron. He "turns" to the conversation.

David smiles.

DAVID ROCKEFELLER (cont'd)

Don't worry. I won't tell him.

Kissinger looks over David's shoulders.

KISSINGER
Well... he was always on time.

Nelson, a visibly extroverted Rockefeller walks to the book presenter.

NELSON ROCKEFELLER
Henry.

KISSINGER
(nods)
Nelson.

The CFR member watches the VIP group from a few meters away and takes a sip of scotch whiskey. His wife tries adjusting her reading glasses.

CFR WOMAN
Is that Nelson and David Rockefeller?

CFR MAN
No Lauren. (pointing to Nelson) That is Dr. Jekyll and this (pointing to David) is Mr. Hyde.

An ice cube is placed in Nelson's Bourbon.

NELSON ROCKEFFELER
Ike's finest hour is behind him. He just doesn't know it yet.

Kissinger nods.

DAVID ROCKEFELLER
He's a great general. Don't forget that.

NELSON ROCKEFFELER
Was. But you know what; peace is the hardest operation.

Nelson gives Kissinger the Bourbon and takes another glass from the waiter. Kissinger reluctantly takes a sip.

NELSON ROCKEFELLER
I'm might have to run, Henry.*

Henry is visibly surprised and swallows the Bourbon. David knew all along as his grin indicates.

GOGO CONTINUE HERE *not clear: governor or president. I guess at that time he was only thinking of running for governor.

Kramer warning (originally letter) through hallucination dream? Not human. Too many important, not enough real people
Ferguson 390

New York City gets destroyed during dialogue.

KISSINGER (V.O.)
When I went into the army I was a
refugee and when I got out I was an
immigrant.

Harvard Time. Introduce Smoky.

KISSINGER (V.O.) (cont'd)
In the life of every person there
comes a point when he realizes that
out of all the seemingly limitless
possibilities of youth he has in fact
become one actuality.

Last day in Germany.

KRAEMER
You need an education. Go to a fine
college. A gentleman does not go to
the College of the City of New York.

Show loss of religion. No humour or social sensibilities.

Israel question. Kissingers argument: opposition, it would
alienate the Arabs and jeopardize US interests.

Ann Fleischer marriage (Feb 1949, p 223)

Letter to Kramer:

Kissinger is sitting in his dorm room writing a letter. Nov
1949

KISSINGER (V.O.)

Perhaps man's striving for value, the certainty of greater truths can never be approached with the pedantic method of philosophy, but needs the poet who sees the totality of life not just its manifestations.

Kraemer [makes activity in army].

KRAEMER (V.O.)

Omit the first word in the above statement.

To Kissinger "Do you remember what I told you back in Germany: Where there are no absolute values, there is spiritual emptiness. The worst thing about a loss of faith is not that someone has stopped believing something, but that they are ready to believe anything."

Scene 5 Moving back into Germany. Marche. Lethal Danger (check Ferguson Book)

Beginning of Cold War:

KISSINGER

Calculations of absolute power lead to a paralysis of action... strength depends on the relative position of states.

To divine the direction on a calm sea may prove more difficult than to chart a course through tempestuous waters, where the violence of the elements imparts inspiration through the need of survival.

Nations learn only by experience; they 'know' only when it is too late to act. But statesmen must act as if their intuition were already experience, as if their aspiration were truth.

(in these periods) the knave and the hero, the traitor and the statesman are distinguished, not by their acts, but by their motives.

New concept. After triangle dramaturgy at end of scene.

Kissinger: "A local war that is also nuclear."

1972 exchange with Nixon on intellectuals.

Kissinger: "They believe in manipulation, Mr President. And therefore, it grates on them. In this society, intellectuals are not as a class highly respected; that gets them."

Wallace Stanlay/Kissinger: "the reason academic politics are so bitter is that so little is at stake."

Kissinger: "in any dispute, the intensity of feeling is inversely proportional to the value of the issues at stake."

New York Nuclear Weapons and Foreign Policy

Skip Harvard as Professor

Kennedy, Johnson and Rockefeller

Nixon (Main Part of Story)

INT. ROOSEVELT ROOM - WHITE HOUSE - NIGHT (MAY 17 1972)

A Michelin star chef shakes a cocktail that gets handed over to the president of Princeton College Robert F. Goheen.

Six other presidents of Ivy League colleges are present in the room. Most of them are standing beside the bar waiting to have a chat with Kissinger who just happens to open the door.

The look on their faces suggests however, that they are not pleased with the decisions of the White House and in particular of their former associate.

Kissinger feels like being in the wrong movie as Robert approaches him with a drink in his hand.

ROBERT GOHEEN
(hands over a Bloody
Mary)
Here Henry, I thought this might
satisfy your thirst for blood.

Kissinger slowly takes the glass and places it next to him. Not taking a sip.

KISSINGER

Excuse me sir?

ROBERT GOHEEN

You seem to enjoy destruction...
Unnecessary suffering for reasons
that are not clear and for a cause
that noone seems willing to defend.

KISSINGER

Colluding with the North Vietnamese
means the imposition of communist
rule which would...

ROBERT GOHEEN

Be that as it may, it is turning
large numbers of young people away
from their country.

KISSINGER

I am more than aware of your students
views but we in government have an
obligation not only to register what
they say but also to put it into the
framework of the longer term.

Two more university presidents have joined the round. The
president of Cornell starts to grin.

CORNELL PRESIDENT

None of my students would care if
Saigon fell.

PENNSYLVANIA PRESIDENT

(laughing)

I doubt they could even point to it
on a map.

KISSINGER

(trying to suppress
his annoyance)

We were willing to take any
reasonable step but turning Vietnam
over to Communism was not a
reasonable...

ROBERT GOHEEN

Henry, your principles might be
persuasive, including your principle
of "not letting one group dominate
another". But since we did not help
people in similar circumstances
elsewhere, why did we have to do it
now?

(MORE)

ROBERT GOHEEN (cont'd)
Why do we have to do it in Vietnam?
... I don't see how we can run our
universities if the war escalates.

Kissinger takes a long sip from the Bloody Mary and stares
his interlocutors in the eyes.

KISSINGER
So unless we defended every moral
purpose everywhere, we had no right
to defend any principle anywhere.

Robert Goheen thinks for a second. His answer is inaudible
to the viewer.

INT. OVAL OFFICE - WHITE HOUSE - DAY (MAY 17 1972)

NIXON (O.S)
What distinguishes me from Johnson is
that I have the will in spades. I
want the military and I want the NSC
staff to come up with ideas on their
own which will recommend action that
is strong, threatening and effective.

INT. NEWSWEEK OFFICE - EVENING (APRIL 2 1975)

Bruce Van Voorst, an energetic, up-and-coming reporter spins
his pencil as he talks with the Secretary of State over the
telephone.

VAN VOORST
There is a school of thought around
town that there is a question of
whether this crisis is sort of self-
created.

INT. WHITE HOUSE - EVENING (APRIL 2 1975)

Kissinger shakes his head.

KISSINGER
When you predict things, you're
accused of causing what you
predicted.

INT. NEWSWEEK OFFICE - EVENING (APRIL 2 1975)

Van Voorst takes writes into his notebook, crossing out certain questions.

VAN VOORST
The Vietnam thing, is it not, more
your personal involment?

KISSINGER (O.S.)
Come on. What is my personal
involvement?

Van Voorst closes his notebook and sits upright. His pitch is slightly lowered.

VAN VOORST
Getting the agreement.

A sigh can be heard over the telephone.

KISSINGER (O.S.)
Which was made useless after the U.S.
was deprived the means of enforcing
it. You tell me...

INT. WHITE HOUSE - EVENING (APRIL 2 1975)

KISSINGER
... would any treaties have been
maintained when no party was willing
to enforce it?

VAN VOORST
It has happened. Now tell me
Secretary...

INT. UNITED STATES CAPITOL - DAY (APRIL 16 1975?)

Kissinger reads the letter from Sirik Matak, former Prime Minister of Camboida. The congresspeople listen passively.

KISSINGER
I thank you for your offer to
transport me towards freedom. I
cannot leave in such a cowardly
fashion.

(MORE)

KISSINGER (cont'd)
As for you, I never believed for a
moment that you would have this
sentiment of abandoning a people
which has chosen liberty...

Kissinger takes a sip of water.

KISSINGER (cont'd)
You have refused us your protection,
and we can do nothing about it.

INT. PHNOM PENG - DAY (APRIL 1975?)

Sirik Matak is in his office in Phnom Peng. He uses a
fountain pen to write the letter in french.

SIRIK MATAK (V.O.)
... You leave, and my wish is that
you and your country will find
happiness under this sky. But, mark
it well, that if I shall die here on
the spot and in my country that I
love, it is too bad, because we all
are born and must die one day. I have
only committed this mistake...

EXT. PHNOM PENG VARIOUS - DAY

The chaotic evacuation is in full swing as Americans and
Cambodians are running towards the helicopters that lift
them to freedom.

SIRIK MATAK (V.O.)
... of believing in you, the
Americans.

[Latter in the script Matak is shot in the stomach and left
without medical help. It takes him three days to die]

INT. STATE DEPARTMENT - MORNING (APRIL 22 1975)

The front page of The New York Times shows an image of
Kissinger. The man holds up the newspaper to quote it over
the telephone.

KISSINGER

Defense department wishes total evacuation, but that son of a bitch Kissinger, who is thinking of national honor and dignity of the United States won't permit it.

WILLIAM CLEMENTS (O.S.)

Goddamn.

He puts the newspaper back on the table, turned over.

KISSINGER

You know, you guys [...] really ought to be ashamed of yourselves! I'm trying to leave a little self-respect. You guys were the ones who had 57,000 people [...] killed over there!

INT. PENTAGON - MORNING (APRIL 22 1975)

William Clements, Deputy Secretary of Defense looks unwell.

KISSINGER (O.S.)

... you ought to defend them too! Not just me.

Clements clears his throat. His voice is now almost silent in comparison with Kissinger's tantrum.

CLEMENTS

You know... Henry...

INT. STATE DEPARTMENT - MORNING (APRIL 22 1975)

KISSINGER

Don't you think... the disgrace of the United States of packing up and leaving everybody.

INT. PENTAGON - MORNING (APRIL 22 1975)

CLEMENTS

Well, I'm terribly sorry, Henry.

INT. STATE DEPARTMENT - MORNING (APRIL 22 1975)

Kissinger stands up, probably to leave for another meeting.

KISSINGER

If you want to get your goddamn personnel out, why don't you just pack up and get it out? My guys will stay.

CLEMENTS (O.S.)

Hmmm. I thought surely when you and Jim went off together yesterday, you would solve that problem.

KISSINGER

You know there is a presidential order we are going to - first of all we might trigger the goddamnedest panic ever, if we pulled everyone out at once.

INT. CONNECTICUT HOUSE BEDROOM - DAWN (NOVEMBER 29 2023)

Kissinger is lying in his bed, starrng at the ceiling of his country house. Sweat runs over his face and he can't bring himself to sit upright.

It is as if, instead of awaking from a nightmare, he is living in one.

KISSINGER

(whispering)

Sie kommen.

They're coming.

He looks at the door to his room and reaches his hand up.

KISSINGER (cont'd)

Walter, die Nazis sind da.

Walter, the nazis are here.

On the desk there are family pictures of the young Kissinger's standing in the garden of their grandparents house.

KISSINGER (cont'd)

Das Pogrom beginnt. Das Pogrom beginnt.

The pogrom begins. The pogrom begins.

Through the window we see the outside of the country house although the fog leaves much of the landscape in mystery.

INT. CONNECTICUT HOUSE HALLWAY - MORNING

We fly through the hallway of the house, past memorabilia that is displayed on desks. There is a luxurious Chinese vase next to a 19th century globe. A document written in Russian is also framed on the wall.

The light of another room is turned on. We can hear people chatting and the sound of a coffee machine...

INT. CONNECTICUT HOUSE BEDROOM - MORNING

... that Kissinger also notices.

KISSINGER

Walter wach auf!

Walter wake up!

Next to the childhood photo there is a funeral portrait of the brother reading "Walter Kissinger 1924-2021".

Kissinger tries to get up by holding onto the side of the bed. For a moment the first sunlight touches his face but he falls back down into darkness.

There is a knock on the door.

KISSINGER (cont'd)

No, no, no.

With his hand he tries pushing against the door even though it is 5 meters away.

The door opens and two people enter.

They are out of focus from the point of view of Kissinger. His fearful face turns into acceptance of his faith.

David and Elizabeth slowly walk towards their father.

Elizabeth takes the hand that is still in the process of holding back the door to help Kissinger up.

David tries to make eye contact but his father looks past him.

He turns his head out the window and points to the garden where now a wooden pavilion is visible.

KISSINGER (cont'd)
 (to himself)
Da bist du Walter.

There you are Walter.

The children smile towards each other.

 KISSINGER (cont'd)
Da bist du.

The camera goes through the window...

EXT. CONNECTICUT HOUSE GARADEN - MORNING

... and towards the pavilion where a 16 year old Walter appears. He is dressed in summer clothes and even has a slight tan from all the outdoor work. Walter carves a piece of furniture whose shape hasn't been defined yet.

He looks back to the empty window, smiles and waves.